

COMMON NOTES ARE HIP!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #133

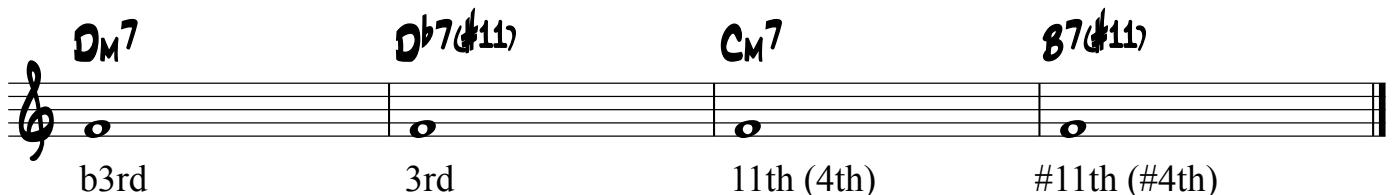
A great way to play through chords that look a little scary, unfamiliar, or atypical is to find a Common Note that works between two, three, even four chords in a row. This is definitely related to Voice Leading, but it's good to think of this approach as it's own thing. It's sort of like doing a jazz sudoku or crossword puzzle. Start with a theory, a guess, and then follow it along and see how it goes.

Prioritize chord tones first (1, 3, 5, 7), and upper extensions next (9ths, 11ths, etc). A good line of Common Tones is great, as it gives you a solid path through the chord changes. With this path, you can then use rhythmic ideas, melodic embellishment or anything else you can think of to turn your one note into something much greater than you might imagine.

#1 - Some potentially tricky chords



#2 - A Common Note that works across all four chords



#3 - Embellishing a melody around our Common Note

